

Absolutely — here is the **fully redone TORCH curation**, now incorporating the omitted culinary, sports, figurative-destruction, torch-song, broader technical, and transmission/legacy branches. I'm replacing the earlier version rather than treating this as a patch.

## # TORCH

### ## 1. Passage anchor

> “Once, she used nothing more than a cup, a **torch**, and a shadow on the wall to explain a difficult idea about light...”

#### ### Passage meaning

**torch** = a small portable electric light, usually powered by batteries

**手電筒**

This is standard **British English**.

In American English, the ordinary word is:

> **flashlight**

#### ### Practice

1. She shone a **torch** at the cup to create a shadow.

她用**手電筒**照向杯子，製造出影子。

2. I used a **torch** to look under the desk.

我用**手電筒**照桌子底下。

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## # Core meanings of TORCH

### ## 2. torch — portable electric light

= a small handheld electric light, especially in British English

**手電筒**

This is the exact passage sense.

#### ### Examples

1. Take a **torch** with you in case it gets dark.

帶一支**手電筒**，以防天黑。

2. He switched on his **torch**.

他打開了**手電筒**。

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### ## 3. shine a torch

= direct the beam of a torch at something

**用手電筒照**

#### ### Examples

1. She **shone the torch on the wall**.

她用**手電筒照牆壁**。

2. He **shone a torch into the box**.

他用**手電筒照進盒子裡**。

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### ## 4. torch beam

= beam of light produced by a torch

**手電筒光束**

#### ### Examples

1. The **torch beam** moved across the wall.

**手電筒光束**掃過牆面。

2. I could see dust floating in the **torch beam**.

我得到灰塵在**手電筒光束**中飄動。

This is a useful collocation, not a separate lexical sense.

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### # Burning torch / firebrand

### ## 5. torch — burning stick used for light

= a stick with combustible material at one end, burned to provide light

**火把；火炬**

#### ### Examples

1. They carried burning **torches** through the tunnel.

他們拿著燃燒的**火把**穿過隧道。

2. The entrance was lit by **torches**.

入口由**火把**照亮。

This is an older and historically central sense.

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### ## 6. flaming torch

= a torch visibly burning with flame

**燃燒的火把；火炬**

#### ### Examples

1. The runner carried a **flaming torch**.

跑者拿著一支燃燒的**火炬**。

2. Guards stood beside the gate holding **flaming torches**.

守衛拿著燃燒的**火把**站在大門旁。

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### # Ceremonial / symbolic torch

### ## 7. Olympic torch

= ceremonial torch associated with the Olympic Games

**奧運火炬**

#### ### Examples

1. She was chosen to carry the **Olympic torch**.

她獲選傳遞**奧運火炬**。

2. The **Olympic torch** arrived in the city.

**奧運火炬**抵達了這座城市。

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### ## 8. torch relay

= event in which a ceremonial torch is passed from one runner to another

**火炬接力**

### ### Examples

1. Thousands watched the \*\*torch relay\*\*.

數千人觀看了\*\*火炬接力\*\*。

2. He took part in the \*\*torch relay\*\*.

他參加了\*\*火炬接力\*\*。

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## ## 9. torchbearer

### ### A. literal

= person who physically carries a torch

\*\*火炬手\*\*

### ### B. figurative

= person who strongly represents or continues a cause, movement, tradition, or ideal

\*\*傳承者；代表人物；旗手\*\*

### ### Examples

1. She was selected as an Olympic \*\*torchbearer\*\*.

她獲選成為奧運\*\*火炬手\*\*。

2. He became a \*\*torchbearer for educational reform\*\*.

他成為教育改革的\*\*代表人物 / 傳承者\*\*。

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## # Technical heat-producing tool

## ## 10. torch — tool producing intense directed heat

= device producing a concentrated flame or hot jet for heating, cutting, welding, melting, etc.

\*\*噴燈；噴炬；焊炬；切割炬\*\*

### ### Examples

1. The worker used a \*\*torch\*\* to cut the metal.

工人用\*\*切割炬\*\*切割金屬。

2. The pipe was heated with a gas \*\*torch\*\*.

管子用瓦斯\*\*噴燈\*\*加熱。

This is especially common in American technical English.

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## ## 11. blowtorch

= portable tool producing an intense flame

\*\*噴燈；噴火槍\*\*

### ### Examples

1. He used a \*\*blowtorch\*\* to heat the metal.  
他用\*\*噴燈\*\*加熱金屬。
2. A \*\*blowtorch\*\* can produce very high temperatures.  
\*\*噴燈\*\*可以產生很高的溫度。

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## ## 12. welding torch

= torch used in welding

\*\*焊炬；焊槍\*\*

### ### Examples

1. The technician adjusted the \*\*welding torch\*\*.  
技術人員調整了\*\*焊炬\*\*。
2. Protective equipment is essential when using a \*\*welding torch\*\*.  
使用\*\*焊炬\*\*時必須配戴防護裝備。

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## ## 13. cutting torch

= torch used to cut metal

\*\*切割炬；切割噴槍\*\*

### ### Examples

1. The worker used a \*\*cutting torch\*\* on the steel plate.  
工人用\*\*切割炬\*\*切割鋼板。

2. A **cutting torch** can slice through thick metal.

**切割炬**可以切穿厚金屬。

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## ## 14. propane / gas torch

= torch using propane or another gas as fuel

**丙烷噴槍**；**瓦斯噴燈**

### ### Examples

1. He used a **propane torch** to heat the pipe.

他用**丙烷噴槍**加熱管子。

2. A small **gas torch** is useful for repair work.

小型**瓦斯噴燈**很適合維修工作。

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## ## 15. plasma torch

= device producing an extremely hot jet of ionized gas

**電漿炬**；**等離子炬**

### ### Examples

1. A **plasma torch** can reach extremely high temperatures.

**電漿炬**可以達到極高溫度。

2. The material was treated with a **plasma torch**.

材料使用**電漿炬**處理。

Specialist but established.

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## # Culinary use

## ## 16. kitchen torch / culinary torch

= handheld gas torch used to brown, caramelize, char, or sear food

**料理噴槍**；**廚房噴槍**；**炙燒槍**

### ### Examples

1. Use a **kitchen torch** to caramelize the sugar.

用**料理噴槍**把糖炙燒成焦糖。

2. The chef finished the dish with a **culinary torch**.

主廚最後用**料理噴槍**完成這道菜。

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### ## 17. torch food

= apply a direct torch flame to the surface of food

**用噴槍炙燒；火焰炙燒**

#### ### Examples

1. The chef **torched the salmon** before serving it.

主廚上菜前把鮭魚**用噴槍炙燒了一下**。

2. **Torch the sugar** until it caramelizes.

用噴槍**炙燒表面的糖**，直到焦糖化。

This is an important modern culinary verb sense.

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### ## 18. torched salmon / tuna / cheese / meringue

= food whose surface has been quickly browned, charred, or caramelized with a torch

**炙燒鮭魚 / 吞拿魚 / 起司 / 蛋白霜**

#### ### Examples

1. We ordered **torched salmon**.

我們點了**炙燒鮭魚**。

2. The dessert was topped with **torched meringue**.

甜點上面放了**炙燒蛋白霜**。

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# Verb: deliberately burn

### ## 19. torch — deliberately set fire to something

= intentionally burn a building, vehicle, object, etc.

**縱火燒毀；放火燒**

### ### Examples

1. The abandoned car was **\*\*torched\*\*** overnight.  
那輛廢棄汽車在夜間被**\*\*放火燒毀\*\***。
2. Several buildings were **\*\*torched\*\*** during the unrest.  
幾棟建築在騷亂期間被**\*\*縱火焚燒\*\***。

Strong, informal, often journalistic.

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### # Figurative destruction / severe damage

#### ## 20. torch something figuratively

= badly damage or ruin something such as finances, reputation, prospects, or a plan  
**\*\*重創；毀掉；嚴重損害\*\***

### ### Examples

1. One bad investment **\*\*torched his savings\*\***.  
一次糟糕的投資**\*\*重創了他的積蓄\*\***。
2. The scandal **\*\*torched the company's reputation\*\***.  
那場醜聞**\*\*嚴重損害了公司的聲譽\*\***。

Informal and vivid.

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#### ## 21. torch someone/something with criticism

= criticize extremely harshly  
**\*\*猛烈批評；痛批；抨擊\*\***

### ### Examples

1. Critics **\*\*torched the film\*\***.  
評論家**\*\*猛烈批評了這部電影\*\***。
2. Commentators **\*\*torched the proposal\*\***.  
評論人士**\*\*痛批這項提議\*\***。

Lower priority, but established in informal journalistic usage.

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## # Sports use

### ## 22. torch an opponent / defense

= perform extremely successfully against an opponent, especially in sports

**\*\*痛擊；打爆；徹底壓制\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. He **\*\*torched the defense for 35 points\*\***.  
他攻下35分，**\*\*徹底打爆了對方防守\*\***。
2. The striker **\*\*torched the opposition\*\*** in the second half.  
那名前鋒在下半場**\*\*徹底壓制了對手\*\***。

Especially common in North American sports language.

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### ## 23. get torched

= be badly beaten, exposed, or outperformed

**\*\*被打爆；被徹底壓制\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. The defense **\*\*got torched\*\*** in the second half.  
防守線在下半場**\*\*被打爆了\*\***。
2. He **\*\*got torched\*\*** by a faster opponent.  
他被速度更快的對手**\*\*徹底壓制\*\***。

Informal.

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## # Romantic idiom

### ## 24. carry a torch for someone

= continue to have romantic feelings for someone, often when the feelings are not returned

**\*\*仍然愛慕某人；暗戀某人；舊情未了\*\***

### ### Examples

1. He still **\*\*carries a torch for her\*\***.  
他仍然**\*\*愛慕著她\*\***。
2. She had **\*\*carried a torch for him\*\*** for years.  
她多年來一直**\*\*暗戀著他\*\***。

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### # Legacy / succession metaphor

#### ## 25. pass the torch

= hand responsibility, leadership, knowledge, or a tradition to another person  
**\*\*交棒；傳承；把使命交給下一代\*\***

### ### Examples

1. The founder decided to **\*\*pass the torch\*\*** to a younger leader.  
創辦人決定把責任**\*\*交棒給較年輕的領導者\*\***。
2. Great teachers eventually **\*\*pass the torch\*\*** to the next generation.  
優秀老師最終會把經驗與使命**\*\*傳承給下一代\*\***。

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#### ## 26. take up the torch

= accept responsibility for continuing a cause, tradition, or role  
**\*\*接棒；接下使命\*\***

### ### Examples

1. Younger researchers **\*\*took up the torch\*\***.  
年輕研究人員**\*\*接下了這項使命\*\***。
2. She **\*\*took up the torch\*\*** after her mentor retired.  
她的導師退休後，她**\*\*接棒繼續下去\*\***。

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#### ## 27. carry the torch

= continue a tradition, cause, mission, or responsibility  
**\*\*延續使命；承擔傳承；繼續推動\*\***

### ### Examples

1. Younger scientists are now **carrying the torch**.  
年輕科學家現在正**接續這份使命**。
2. She hopes her students will **carry the torch**.  
她希望學生能**把這份理念傳承下去**。

### ### Important distinction

**carry a torch for someone**

→ **仍愛慕某人**

**carry the torch**

→ **延續使命 / 傳統**

These are separate idiomatic branches.

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### # Literary symbolic use

#### ## 28. torch of knowledge / freedom / hope

= literary metaphor for an ideal being carried, preserved, or passed on

**知識 / 自由 / 希望的火炬**

### ### Examples

1. Teachers help carry the **torch of knowledge**.  
老師幫助傳遞**知識的火炬**。
2. The monument represents the **torch of freedom**.  
這座紀念碑象徵**自由的火炬**。

Literary rather than everyday.

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### # Music / romantic longing

#### ## 29. torch song

= sentimental song about lost, unhappy, or unreturned love

**失戀情歌 ; 傷感情歌 ; 單戀情歌**

### ### Examples

1. She performed an old \*\*torch song\*\*.  
她演唱了一首老式的\*\*傷感情歌\*\*。
2. The singer became famous for dramatic \*\*torch songs\*\*.  
那位歌手以充滿感情的\*\*失戀情歌\*\*聞名。

This develops from \*\*carry a torch for someone\*\*.

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### ## 30. torch singer

= singer known for performing torch songs

\*\*傷感情歌歌手；失戀情歌歌手\*\*

### ### Examples

1. She became known as a \*\*torch singer\*\*.  
她後來以演唱\*\*傷感情歌\*\*聞名。
2. Classic \*\*torch singers\*\* often used highly expressive vocal styles.  
傳統的\*\*傷感情歌歌手\*\*常使用情感強烈的唱法。

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### ## 31. torch singing

= style or practice of singing torch songs

\*\*傷感情歌演唱；失戀情歌演唱風格\*\*

### ### Example

Her voice was especially suited to \*\*torch singing\*\*.  
她的聲音特別適合演唱\*\*傷感情歌\*\*。

Lower priority.

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### # Torchlight family

### ## 32. torchlight

= light produced by a torch

**\*\*手電筒光；火把光\*\***

### ### Examples

1. We walked by **\*\*torchlight\*\***.

我們靠著**\*\*手電筒光\*\***走路。

2. Their faces were visible in the **\*\*torchlight\*\***.

他們的臉在**\*\*火把光\*\***中看得見。

Meaning depends on the sense of **\*\*torch\*\*** in context.

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### ## 33. torchlit

= illuminated by torches

**\*\*由火把 / 火炬照亮的\*\***

### ### Examples

1. They followed a **\*\*torchlit path\*\***.

他們沿著一條**\*\*火把照亮的小路\*\***走。

2. The ceremony took place in a **\*\*torchlit courtyard\*\***.

儀式在一個**\*\*由火炬照亮的庭院\*\***舉行。

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### ## 34. torchlight procession / parade

= procession in which people carry burning torches

**\*\*火炬遊行；火把遊行\*\***

### ### Examples

1. The festival ended with a **\*\*torchlight procession\*\***.

節慶以一場**\*\*火炬遊行\*\***結束。

2. Thousands joined the **\*\*torchlight parade\*\***.

數千人參加了**\*\*火把遊行\*\***。

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### # Regional English

### ## 35. torch vs flashlight

#### ### British English

**\*\*torch\*\*** = **\*\*手電筒\*\***

#### ### American English

**\*\*flashlight\*\*** = **\*\*手電筒\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. BrE: Have you got a **\*\*torch\*\***?

你有**\*\*手電筒\*\***嗎？

2. AmE: Do you have a **\*\*flashlight\*\***?

你有**\*\*手電筒\*\***嗎？

This distinction is essential for the passage.

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#### # Key contrasts

### ## 36. torch vs flashlight

They normally refer to the same portable electric object, but regional usage differs:

\* BrE → **\*\*torch\*\***

\* AmE → **\*\*flashlight\*\***

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### ## 37. torch vs lamp

**\*\*torch\*\***

= portable handheld source of light

**\*\*lamp\*\***

= light-producing device usually placed, mounted, or fixed somewhere

**\*\*燈；燈具\*\***

Compare:

> handheld **\*\*torch\*\***

> 手電筒

> desk **\*\*lamp\*\***

> 檯燈

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### ## 38. torch vs lantern

**\*\*lantern\*\***

= enclosed portable or hanging light source

**\*\*提燈；燈籠\*\***

**\*\*torch\*\***

= portable flashlight in BrE or burning stick/firebrand in another sense

Compare:

> camping **\*\*lantern\*\***

> 露營燈

> electric **\*\*torch\*\***

> 手電筒

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### ## 39. torch vs flame

**\*\*flame\*\***

= visible burning gas/fire itself

**\*\*火焰\*\***

**\*\*torch\*\***

= object or device producing/carrying that flame

Compare:

> The **\*\*torch\*\*** produced a bright **\*\*flame\*\***.

> 火炬產生了明亮的火焰。

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### ## 40. torch vs blowtorch

**\*\*torch\*\***

= broad word, depending on dialect/context

**\*\*blowtorch\*\***

= specifically a device producing an intense directed flame

**\*\*噴燈；噴火槍\*\***

A kitchen torch is a type of small blowtorch-like device.

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## ## 41. torch food vs grill / sear

**\*\*torch\*\***

= apply flame directly to the surface, usually briefly

**\*\*噴槍炙燒\*\***

**\*\*grill\*\***

= cook using radiant/direct heat over a broader area

**\*\*烤；燒烤\*\***

**\*\*sear\*\***

= brown the surface rapidly using intense heat

**\*\*煎封；高溫炙燒\*\***

Food can be **\*\*torched\*\*** in order to **\*\*sear\*\*** or brown its surface, but the verbs do not describe exactly the same technique.

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## # Meaning map

The historical core of **\*\*torch\*\*** is:

**\*\*a portable source of intense light or flame\*\***

From this develop several branches:

### ### Portable light

torch

→ **\*\*手電筒\*\*** in BrE

### ### Burning firebrand

torch

→ **\*\*火把；火炬\*\***

### ### Ceremony

Olympic torch

→ \*\*奧運火炬\*\*

### ### Technical heat tool

welding / cutting / gas torch

→ \*\*焊炬 / 切割炬 / 噴燈\*\*

### ### Cooking

torch salmon / sugar

→ \*\*用噴槍炙燒\*\*

### ### Literal destruction

torch a car

→ \*\*放火燒毀\*\*

### ### Figurative destruction

torch a reputation / savings

→ \*\*重創；毀掉\*\*

### ### Sports

torch the defense

→ \*\*打爆 / 徹底壓制\*\*

### ### Romantic longing

carry a torch for someone

→ \*\*暗戀 / 舊情未了\*\*

### ### Tradition / responsibility

pass / carry / take up the torch

→ \*\*交棒 / 傳承 / 接棒\*\*

### ### Music

torch song

→ \*\*傷感失戀情歌\*\*

The passage uses the first branch:

**\*\*torch = portable electric flashlight in British English\*\*.**

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## # MCQ-ready master list

| Form / sense                                   | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                                          | -----                                 |
| <b>**torch — BrE portable electric light**</b> | 手持、通常以電池供電的便攜式電燈；手電筒                  |
| <b>**shine a torch**</b>                       | 用手電筒把光照向某個地方或物體                       |
| <b>**torch — burning stick**</b>               | 一端燃燒、用來照明的火把 / 火炬                     |
| <b>**flaming torch**</b>                       | 正燃燒著的火把 / 火炬                          |
| <b>**Olympic torch**</b>                       | 奧運會傳遞聖火所使用的火炬                         |
| <b>**torch relay**</b>                         | 多人輪流傳遞火炬的接力活動                         |
| <b>**torchbearer — literal**</b>               | 在典禮或接力中實際攜帶火炬的人；火炬手                   |
| <b>**torchbearer — figurative**</b>            | 延續或代表某種理念、傳統或運動的人；傳承者 / 代表人物          |
| <b>**torch — technical heat tool**</b>         | 產生集中高溫火焰或熱流、用於焊接 / 切割 / 加熱的噴炬         |
| <b>**blowtorch**</b>                           | 產生強烈高溫火焰的噴燈 / 噴火槍                     |
| <b>**welding torch**</b>                       | 用於焊接的焊炬 / 焊槍                          |
| <b>**cutting torch**</b>                       | 用於切割金屬的切割炬                            |
| <b>**gas/propane torch**</b>                   | 以瓦斯 / 丙烷為燃料的噴燈 / 噴槍                   |
| <b>**plasma torch**</b>                        | 利用高溫電漿熱流工作的電漿炬 / 等離子炬                 |
| <b>**kitchen/culinary torch**</b>              | 用來焦糖化、炙燒食物表面的料理噴槍                     |
| <b>**torch food**</b>                          | 用直接火焰快速炙燒、焦化或上色食物表面                   |
| <b>**torched salmon/tuna/etc.**</b>            | 表面經噴槍快速炙燒處理的食物                        |
| <b>**torch — set fire to**</b>                 | 故意放火燒毀建築、車輛等                          |
| <b>**torch something figuratively**</b>        | 嚴重破壞名聲、財務、計畫等；重創 / 毀掉                 |
| <b>**torch — criticize severely**</b>          | 對某人、作品或提議作非常猛烈的批評                     |
| <b>**torch an opponent/defense**</b>           | 在比賽中徹底壓制、痛擊對手                         |
| <b>**get torched**</b>                         | 在比賽或競爭中被對手徹底壓制 / 打爆                   |
| <b>**carry a torch for someone**</b>           | 長期對某人懷有浪漫感情；暗戀 / 舊情未了                 |
| <b>**pass the torch**</b>                      | 把責任、領導權、傳統或使命交給下一個人；交棒 / 傳承           |
| <b>**take up the torch**</b>                   | 接下別人的責任、使命或傳統；接棒                      |
| <b>**carry the torch**</b>                     | 延續某種理念、使命或傳統                          |
| <b>**torch of knowledge/freedom/etc.**</b>     | 文學性比喻中象徵理念延續與傳播的火炬                    |
| <b>**torch song**</b>                          | 以失戀、單戀或未得到回應的愛情為主題的傷感情歌               |
| <b>**torch singer**</b>                        | 以演唱傷感 / 失戀情歌聞名的歌手                     |
| <b>**torchlight**</b>                          | 手電筒或火把產生的光                            |
| <b>**torchlit**</b>                            | 被火把 / 火炬照亮的                           |
| <b>**torchlight procession/parade**</b>        | 參與者手持火把進行的火炬 / 火把遊行                   |

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## # Passage recap

> “...she used nothing more than a cup, a **torch**, and a shadow on the wall...”

Here:

**torch** = a portable electric flashlight

Best Traditional Chinese:

\* **手電筒** \*

Natural contextual translation:

**她只用了一個杯子、一支手電筒和牆上的影子.....**

## ### Passage MCQ-ready meaning

**torch**

= a small portable electric light held in the hand, especially in British English

**手電筒**

## ### Essential regional distinction

> **torch** — British English

> → 手電筒

> **flashlight** — American English

> → 手電筒

## ### Essential polysemy contrasts

> **torch a salmon**

> → 用噴槍炙燒鮭魚

> **torch a car**

> → 放火燒毀汽車

> **torch the defense**

> → 打爆 / 徹底壓制防守

> **carry a torch for someone**

> → 仍然暗戀某人

> **pass the torch**

> → **交棒 / 傳承**

> **torch song**

> → **失戀 / 傷感情歌**

The passage itself, however, clearly uses the ordinary British-English **flashlight** sense.